

Weekly Dinner Menu for 2

Quick, high-protein, vegetable-focused dinners with moderate to minimal carbs. Built for 2 adults and designed to stay affordable and easy to cook on weeknights.

Best for

Busy weeknights, fast cleanup, affordable grocery runs

Focus

Protein + vegetables, lighter on carbs

Plan style

5 dinners, 20 to 30 minutes each

Monday

Garlic Chicken and Broccoli Skillet

Serves 2

20 to 25 min

High protein

Low carb

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb chicken thighs or chicken breast
- 1 large head broccoli or 1 bag frozen broccoli
- 1/2 onion, sliced
- 2 to 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- 1 tsp paprika, plus salt and pepper
- Optional: 1 cup cooked rice total

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Heat oil in a skillet over medium-high heat.
2. Season chicken with paprika, salt, and pepper.
3. Cook chicken 6 to 8 minutes until browned and cooked through.
4. Add onion and broccoli, cook 4 to 5 minutes.
5. Add garlic, stir 30 seconds, combine, and serve.

Tuesday

Ground Turkey Taco Bowls

Serves 2

20 min

High protein

Low to moderate carb

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground turkey
- 2 tsp taco seasoning
- 1/2 head lettuce, chopped
- 1 tomato, diced
- 1/2 onion, diced
- 1 bell pepper, diced
- Salsa
- Optional: black beans, cheese, avocado

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Brown ground turkey in a skillet, about 7 to 8 minutes.
2. Add taco seasoning with a splash of water.
3. Split lettuce and vegetables between 2 bowls.
4. Top with turkey, salsa, and any optional toppings.

Wednesday

Beef and Zucchini Stir-Fry

Serves 2

20 to 25 min

High protein

Low carb

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground beef or thin sliced beef
- 2 zucchini, sliced
- 1/2 onion, sliced
- 1 to 1.5 cups frozen mixed vegetables
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 tbsp soy sauce
- 1 tbsp oil and black pepper

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Heat oil and cook beef until browned.
2. Add onion, then zucchini and frozen vegetables.
3. Cook 5 to 6 minutes until tender.
4. Add garlic, soy sauce, and pepper. Stir and serve.

Thursday

Egg Roll in a Bowl

Serves 2

20 min

High protein

Very low carb

INGREDIENTS

- 1 lb ground pork or ground turkey
- 1/2 bag coleslaw mix
- 1/2 onion, sliced
- 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 tbsp soy sauce
- 1 tsp sesame oil, optional
- Optional green onions

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Brown the meat in a large skillet.
2. Add onion, then garlic.
3. Add coleslaw mix and cook until softened.
4. Stir in soy sauce and sesame oil, then serve.

Friday

Sheet Pan Sausage and Vegetables

Serves 2

25 to 30 min

Moderate to high protein

Low carb

INGREDIENTS

- 12 to 14 oz smoked sausage or chicken sausage
- 2 zucchini, chopped
- 1 head broccoli or 1 bag frozen broccoli
- 1 bell pepper, chopped
- 1/2 onion, chopped
- 1 tbsp olive oil
- Salt, pepper, garlic powder

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Preheat oven to 425°F.
2. Spread sausage and vegetables on a sheet pan.
3. Drizzle with oil and season well.
4. Roast 20 to 25 minutes, stirring halfway through.

Optional Leftovers

Easy Lunch Add-On Strategy

Optional

Budget-friendly

- Increase Monday chicken to 1.25 lbs for an extra lunch portion.
- Increase Tuesday turkey to 1.25 lbs if you want leftovers.
- Thursday reheats especially well, so it is the best meal to make extra.

Grocery List for 2

PROTEINS

- 1 lb chicken thighs or chicken breast
- 2 lbs ground turkey total
- 1 lb ground beef
- 1 lb ground pork or more turkey
- 1 package smoked sausage or chicken sausage

VEGETABLES

- 2 heads broccoli or frozen broccoli bags
- 1 head lettuce
- 1 tomato
- 2 to 3 onions
- 4 zucchini
- 2 bell peppers

MORE PRODUCE AND PANTRY

- 1 bag coleslaw mix
- 1 bag frozen mixed vegetables
- 1 bulb garlic
- Olive oil
- Salt and pepper
- Paprika
- Garlic powder
- Soy sauce
- Taco seasoning
- Salsa

OPTIONAL EXTRAS

- Black beans
- Shredded cheese
- Sesame oil
- Rice
- Green onions

Budget Notes

- Use chicken thighs instead of chicken breast if cheaper.
- Frozen broccoli is often cheaper and lasts longer.
- Ground turkey carries two meals well and keeps cost down.
- Reuse onion, garlic, and peppers across multiple dinners.
- Skip premium toppings unless you already have them.

Tip: if you shop at Aldi or Walmart, this plan should stay fairly reasonable while still keeping protein high and prep time low.